

smoke and see where the air went, but how would that help you? A DIY needs to be simple, and needs to lend itself to easily replication at the average home.

Also, we often get carried away and tend to use the best hardware for everything, but in order to stay in touch with real-world scenarios, we were forced to curb our enthusiasms, and work with an everyday, run-of-the-mill PC setup.

Another restriction we set upon ourselves was the money we were allowed to spend on this little project. A budget of Rs 1,000 was allocated, because we figured there's no way the average *Digit* reader would be willing to spend more than that on just cooling his or her regular cabinet.

With these things in mind, we set off to our neck of the computer component woods called Lamington Road. We bought three cabinet fans, Rs 50 each; a hard disk cooler, Rs 350; one round IDE cable for a slightly steep Rs 400 (thankfully, they come bundled with most new

motherboards), and then overshot our budget even more, splurging on a little tube of Arctic Silver thermal paste, Rs 400! The Arctic Silver is completely unnecessary for most of you, especially if you're not overclocking your CPUs or GPUs, so forgive us our little indulgence. We also bought a little hand blower for Rs 15 to get rid of accumulated dust.

Smoke Screens

The 12-fan-colleague, mentioned earlier, was shown the folly of his ways using cigarette smoke; however, it's not like *Digit* wants to encourage its readers to take up a bad habit like smoking just to solve airflow problems—we get enough mails from angry parents as it is! So we decided to use incense, the type that most of India uses in prayers and rituals. It's called *dhoop* here, but anything that gives off a lot of smoke will do. Just make sure it doesn't give off too much heat, or you'll end up scorching your eyebrows, or worse still, your cabinet or SATA/IDE cables!

